

consisted of a sick 6-monitor arrangement! But he wasn't satisfied with that and wanted to be inside the game itself. With the money he saved by repairing broken iPhones and other electronics, he bought some VR headsets for cheap through government auctions. But the experience still fell miles short of his hopes. One was either too heavy at 10 pounds, and another had a field of view that felt like looking through a half open door. Even the software wasn't well designed and suffered intense lags. Dissatisfied yet again, Luckey did what he did best: he took the headsets apart.

He realized very soon that this wasn't going to be an easy task. The apparatus used by the VR headsets of that time focused on enhancing and distorting an image from a flat screen to cover the user's field of view while simulating 3D. The optical equipment put to use in these headsets had this entire complex task to themselves and hence, were costly and heavy to use. This was a dead end.



Oculus' first Development Kit, born from the DIY culture
and aimed at democratizing VR

His alternative to this approach was both simple and ingenious. Instead of using the bulky lenses for the distortion, he decided to use cheap, light-weight lenses while using the software to achieve the required distortion. Alongside that, the smartphone race was making mobile screens cheaper, crisper and larger than ever, which he decided to use in his idea. The combination of these two approaches allowed him to make something which had